2.3 NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC DIGITAL NOMAD ROBERT REID



Sharing the World

"Try to say yes when you travel. You'll open yourself up to so many new experiences." —Robert Reid

You might say **Robert Reid** has a pretty great job. As National Geographic's Digital Nomad, he investigates the whys and hows of how we experience the world, sharing his adventures with a global audience via social media, blog posts, and the occasional informal travel video.

Reid has traveled from coast to coast in the United States and extensively abroad, from Vietnam to England to Australia. He's been to Canadian Mountie boot camp, counted mustaches in Siberia, and poked around Atlantic City, New Jersey. He's even parachuted from a World War II-era plane in the middle of Russia. He gets around. Reid uses his own hobbies and interests to build trip itineraries, research articles, and provide a framework for the video storytelling he is famous for. (Look him up!)

^ The East African country of Kenya is only one of the amazing destinations Robert Reid has visited during his career as a travel writer.

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MAIN IDEA Digital Nomad Robert Reid explains how travel enriches our lives.

ROAD TRIPPING

In spite of his extensive international travel experience, Reid admits if he could only visit one country for the rest of his life, it would be the United States. "It's so diverse," he explains, highlighting some of his favorite American places. "I love the Great Plains. Mountains are great, but they get in the way of a good view." He's also fond of New York City because of its cultural icons and famous places. Oregon, Reid's home state, is another favorite location. "Oregon is the most underrated state in the country. It has everything. Coastlines. Waterfalls. You name it. It's also where Lewis and Clark ended their great American road trip."



When he travels, Robert Reid gets to know the locals—in this case, a Rosie the Riveter reenactor he met in Ronks, Pennsylvania.

Reid identifies with Lewis and Clark in many ways. "I think the ultimate road trip of all time belongs to those guys," he says. "Their journey was just so American. Americans take road trips to understand their country, and that's what Lewis and Clark were doing." Reid points out the ability of the explorers to travel 8,000 miles—and survive—more than 200 years ago is downright incredible, but explainable. "They didn't overpack. We know that, because they left us lists of exactly what they brought. They knew how important it was to rely on the knowledge of the locals, so they used native guides who knew the language, the terrain, and the culture. And nearly everyone survived the expedition. That's incredible!"

TIPS FROM A TRAVELER

Most importantly to Reid as a travel writer, Lewis and Clark documented their journey. Extensively. So what suggestions does this travel guru have to offer the average tourist today? First, take photographs—lots of them—because they'll help you remember your trip. Secondly, write about who and what you encounter on your journey. Visit a place from different angles and talk to locals who can offer unique perspectives. For example, says Reid, "Go to Wyoming and find a geologist who is walking every square inch of the state to make maps. That person knows the land better than anyone and knows how to better appreciate things most people miss."

Everywhere he visits, Reid talks to people who live there and tries to see the place from their perspective, not from that of an outsider. "When you travel, do and see the things the locals like to do and see—and make sure you do that with the locals," he advises. Sound advice from someone who knows how to travel.

Check out the Reid on the Road videos online in this history program.

HISTORICAL THINKING

1. **FORM AND SUPPORT OPINIONS** Reid believes it's vital to interact with local residents when you travel. Why does he recommend this? Do you agree? Use evidence in the text to support your answer.
2. **COMPARE AND CONTRAST** What does Robert Reid have in common with Lewis and Clark? How are they different?

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